Accessing and Using the Azure Portal SOP

Table of Contents

1. Accessing and Using the Azure Portal 3
1.1 Description 3
1.2 Architecture Diagram 3
1.3 Lab Steps 4
1.4 Supporting References 5

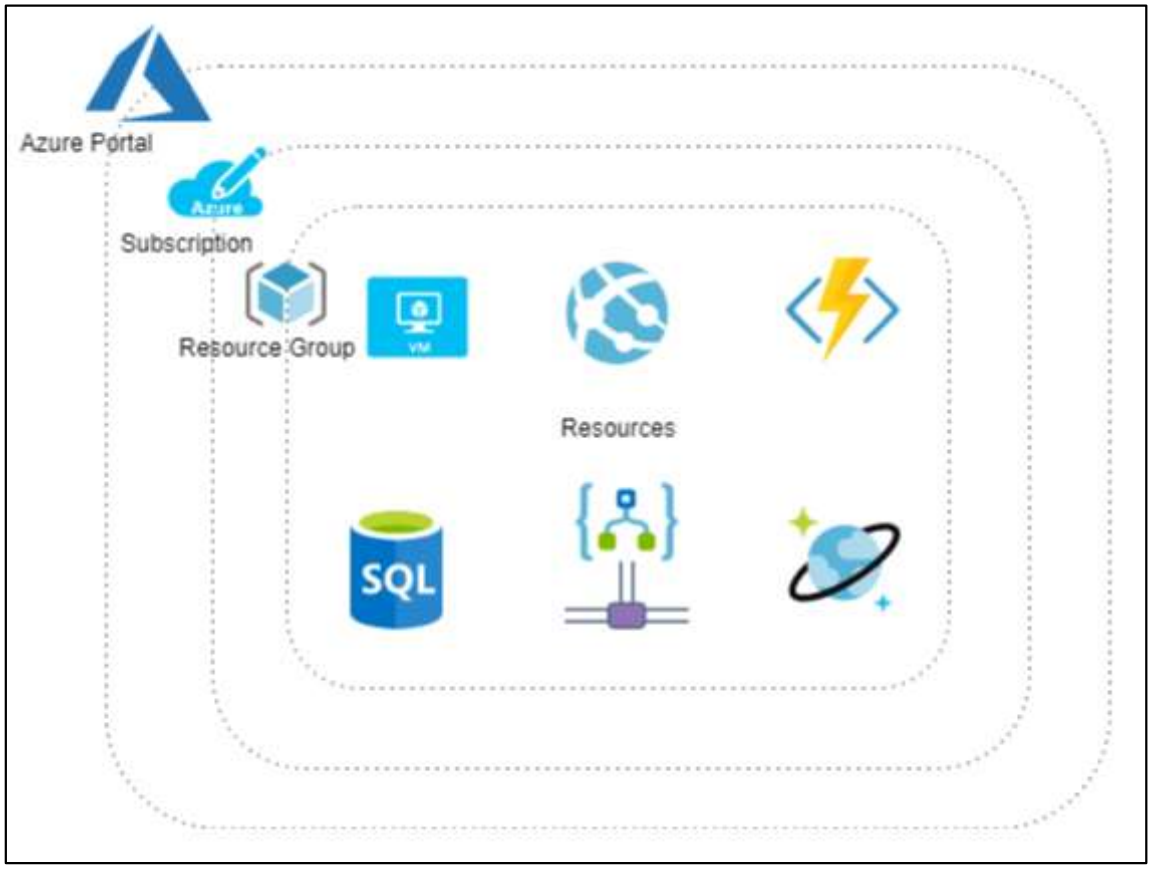
1. Accessing and Using the Azure Portal

1.1 Description

The Azure portal is a web-based, unified console that provides an alternative to command-line tools. With the Azure portal, you can manage your Azure subscription using a graphical user interface. You can build, manage, and monitor everything from simple web apps to complex cloud deployments. Create custom dashboards for an organized view of resources. Configure accessibility options for an optimal experience.

1.2 Architecture Diagram

The diagram below displays a visual representation of the application architecture:



1.3 Lab Steps

Follow the steps outlined below to achieve the objective of this lab exercise:

1. Review of the Azure Portal:
    a. Go to the Azure Portal.
    Note: You can search any service from the Quick Search Bar at top.
    b. Hover over the various buttons present at top. At the right side, there is an icon for **Cloud Shell**.
    c. In **Cloud Shell**, you can perform Azure Command Line Functions, with the help of Azure CLI or PowerShell.
    d. Adjacent to Cloud Shell, is **Directory+Subscription** button, from where you can find information for your Directory.
    e. Next is the **Notifications** Icon, whatever Deployment or update is done within Azure, all notifications can be seen here.
    f. **Settings** Option lets you change the **Theme** and **Layout** for your Azure Account.
    g. The **Question mark** icon refers to **Help+Support**, where you can raise a Support Request to Azure.
    h. At the extreme left, you can find three lines, by clicking on it, you will find a list where various categories of resources are present.
    i. At the bottom of that list is **Cost Management+Billing**, you can find Billing and Usage Details for your account.

2. Provision a Virtual Machine from the Portal:
    a. Go to the Azure Portal and select **Create a resource** > **Compute** > **Virtual Machine**.
    b. Provide the following details and note that the values mentioned are sample ones.
        i. Give Resource Group : Your Resource Group name
        ii. Virtual Machine Name : labvm1
        iii. Region : Any region (Go as per the Lab policies)
        iv. Availability options : No infrastructure redundancy required
        v. Image : Windows Server 2016 Datacenter
        vi. Size : Standard_B1s (Go as per the Lab policies)
        vii. Provide the username and password.
        viii. Public Inbound ports: Select Allow Selected ports.
        ix. Select inbound ports: RDP (3389).
    c. Leave other fields with their default values.
    d. In the **Management blade**, select **Boot diagnostics**: **Off**
    e. Leave other fields with their default values, and click **Review+Create** > **Create**.

3. Dashboard Customization:
    a. Go to Virtual Machine created by you.
    b. You will find a pin icon adjacent to the name of VM.
    c. Click on **Pin** Icon to pin it to Dashboard.
    Note: Similarly, you can pin any resources you want to see in your Dashboard.
    d. Click on the three lines at top left corner and select **Dashboard**.
    e. Click on **New Dashboard**.
    f. You can select the **Tiles** from the left pane and arrange them in right side in the manner you want.
    g. Once you are done arranging your **Tiles**, click on **Done customizing** button at the top.
    h. Give a name to your Dashboard and your **Customized Dashboard** is ready to use.

4. Clean up resources:
    a. When you are done with your lab exercise, delete all the resources created by you.

1.4 Supporting References

Refer the below link for additional information:

1. https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/azure-portal/azure-portal-overview